

National Entrepreneurship Challenge (NEC)

E-Cell, IIT Bombay

Name: Rohan Mehta

Team: Titan - Logistics & Supply Chain

My Motivation

During a summer stint at a regional freight depot in Nagpur, I spent days watching single-truck owners wait up to 48 hours just to get a return load back to their home towns. Nearly 30% of their operational costs went to empty haulage, crippling their profit margins. Large logistics platforms focus heavily on tier-1 metro routes, completely ignoring regional freight hubs.

This gap motivated me to look into low-bandwidth, SMS-and-WhatsApp integrated load-matching systems for semi-literate drivers. For me, entrepreneurship is about walking freight yards, talking to drivers in local dialects, and building practical software that actually puts more daily income into a driver's pocket.

My Expectations from E-Cell

I expect E-Cell to challenge our assumptions about driver onboarding and customer acquisition costs in traditional industries. Logistics isn't a glamorous space, and selling tech to traditional fleet brokers requires a completely different approach than B2C software.

I want NEC to provide hands-on mentorship from supply chain veterans who have built ground-operations businesses in India. I hope to refine our monetization model, learn how to handle delayed payment cycles from enterprise shippers, and sharpen our pitch.